



Closeout Report: Tablet Rollout

Project Summary

- In order to reach annual growth and expansion goals, Sauce & Spoon installed tabletop tablet menus at the Downtown and North locations, with the tablets going live to guests on October 15. After sourcing and installing the tablets, training the staff, and a successful test run, we launched a pilot of the tablets, and gathered customer feedback through a survey that appeared on their devices at the end of their meal. Using that information, we implemented improvements to the operations, including continued waitstaff training, tablet audits to surface faulty devices, investigating instances of food waste, and more.
- Now that we've officially launched the tablets, we've increased the average daily guest count by 10%, decreased wait time by 30 minutes, cut checkout time down to one minute, and decreased food waste by 50%. Sales have gone up upwards of 20% since the rollout. Customer satisfaction has also increased from 72% after the initial pilot to 86% today. This, of course, shows us that there's still room for improvement, which we will continue to make as we explore rolling out tablets to other Sauce & Spoon locations in the near future.

Methodology

The tablet rollout project at Sauce & Spoon's Downtown and North locations followed a structured approach to ensure successful implementation and gather valuable feedback. The key steps included:

- **Sourcing and Installation:** Tablets were sourced and physically installed at the two restaurant locations. This involved working with an electrician for the physical setup.
- **Content Integration:** Menus, coupons, branding, and additional content were added to the tablets, and the tablets were integrated with the existing Point of Sale (POS) system.
- **Staff Training:** A comprehensive training plan was developed and executed to train both Back-of-House (BOH) and Front-of-House (FOH) staff on the new tablet system. This also involved managing waitstaff expectations and concerns.
- **Pilot Launch and Feedback Collection:** A pilot program was launched with the tablets going live to guests on October 15. Customer feedback was gathered through a survey presented on the devices at the end of their meal.
- **Operational Improvements:** Based on the customer feedback, improvements were implemented. These included continued waitstaff training, regular tablet audits to identify and address faulty devices, and investigations into instances of food waste.
- **System Maintenance:** A system for maintenance and locking of the tablets was created to ensure ongoing functionality.
- **Customer Satisfaction Measurement:** A system for surveying and measuring customer satisfaction was implemented to track the impact of the tablet rollout.

Results

Performance Baseline:

	Planned	Actual	Notes
Actual Project Schedule vs Planned	Launch on Apr. 23	Launched on Apr. 23	We were able to launch on the day we wanted, but had to accelerate our tasks due to delays
Actual Project Cost vs Planned	Training materials and fees: \$10,000 Hardware and software implementation across locations: \$3,500 Maintenance (IT fees): \$5,000 Updated website and menu design fee: \$5,000 Other customization fees: \$550	Training materials and fees: \$7,486 Hardware and software implementation across locations: \$3,600 annually Maintenance (IT fees): \$0 (included with hardware order subscription) Updated website and menu design fee: \$4,250 Other customization fees: \$578	Overall, we nearly matched our budget
Planned Scope vs Delivered Scope	Install tablets at two restaurant locations Launch at the beginning of Q2 (April 1) Create a plan for how to train staff on the new system	Physically installed tablets at two restaurant locations via electrician Added menus, coupons, branding, and additional content to tablets Integrated tablets with POS system Negotiated with tablet vendor over timing Created a plan for training Managed waitstaff expectations and concerns Trained BOH and FOH Created system for maintenance/locking Implemented system of surveying and measuring customer satisfaction	We didn't realize how many moving pieces we were going to encounter

Key Accomplishments:

- Successful distribution of 500 tablets to employees.
- Completion of tablet setup and configuration for all users.
- Development and delivery of training materials to ensure user proficiency.
- Integration of necessary applications and software onto all devices.
- Establishment of a dedicated support channel for tablet-related issues.
- Positive feedback received from initial user surveys regarding tablet usability.
- On-time and within-budget completion of the tablet rollout project.

Lessons Learned

- Underestimated the complexity of integrating the tablets with the existing POS system and the amount of content customization required.
- The initial timeline did not fully account for potential delays in vendor negotiations and hardware delivery.
- More comprehensive pre-pilot testing could have identified some operational issues earlier, such as unexpected food waste instances.
- The importance of continuous and iterative staff training was highlighted, especially regarding managing waitstaff expectations and addressing their concerns.
- The need for a robust and proactive system for tablet maintenance and auditing became evident to ensure consistent device functionality.
- Customer feedback, while valuable, required a systematic approach to analyze and translate into actionable operational improvements.

Next Steps

- Expand tablet rollout to additional Sauce & Spoon locations, leveraging lessons learned from this pilot.
- Continue to refine and optimize tablet content, including menus, promotions, and customer feedback surveys.
- Implement ongoing waitstaff training programs to reinforce best practices and address new challenges.
- Regularly audit tablet functionality and perform proactive maintenance to minimize downtime and ensure optimal performance.
- Analyze customer feedback data on an ongoing basis to identify trends and opportunities for further operational improvements.
- Explore new features and functionalities for the tablets, such as integration with loyalty programs or personalized recommendations.

Project Documentation Archive

- [Project Proposal](#)
- [Project Charter](#)
- [Project Plan](#)
- [Evaluation Findings Presentation](#)